

Λυσίας ὁ λογογράφος

Lysias the Orator and the Forensic Speeches of Athens

eul_aid: ejc

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)

Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#)

Domain: [Ῥητορική](#) [Oratory](#)

Format: [Λόγος](#) [Oration](#)

Lysias was a professional speechwriter, or logographer, who worked in Athens during the late 5th and early 4th centuries BCE. He was not an Athenian citizen but a metic, a resident alien. His wealthy family's life was upended by the oligarchic regime known as the Thirty Tyrants, which seized power in 404 BCE. The regime executed his brother and confiscated their property. Lysias escaped and helped fund the democratic resistance.

After democracy was restored, he returned to Athens but was denied citizenship. He then built a career writing courtroom speeches for others to deliver. Over 200 speeches were attributed to him in antiquity, but only 35 survive in whole or in part. Most are forensic speeches, written for real legal cases involving murder, inheritance, business, and politics. One of the most famous, *Against Eratosthenes*, is the only speech he delivered himself, accusing a member of the Thirty Tyrants of killing his brother.

His works are celebrated for their clear, persuasive style that seemed artlessly suited to the character of the client. According to modern scholars, his speeches provide invaluable evidence for Athenian law, daily life, and social history. As a non-citizen, his writings also offer a distinct perspective on Athenian society. His style was highly praised in antiquity and his works became standard models for the study of rhetoric.

Works (36)

- [κατηγορία πρὸς τοὺς συνουσιαστάς κακολογιῶν](#) · [Accusatithe Companions of Slander](#) · 20 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀγοράτου ἐνδείξεως](#) · [Against Agoratus for Informing](#) · 87 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀλκιβιάδου λιποταξίου](#) · [Against Alcibiades for Desertion](#) · 37 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀλκιβιάδου ἀστρατείας](#) · [Against Alcibiades for Military Evasion](#) · 10 passages
- [κατ' Ἀνδοκίδου ἀσεβείας](#) · [Against Andocides for Impiety](#) · 49 passages
- [κατὰ Διογείτονος](#) · [Against Diogeiton](#) · 26 passages
- [κατὰ Ἐπικράτους καὶ τῶν συμπρεσβευτῶν ἐπίλογος](#) · [Against Epicrates and Co-Envoys, Epilogue As Theodorus](#) · 15 passages
- [κατὰ Ερατοσθένους τοῦ γενομένου τῶν τριάκοντα](#) · [Against Eratosthenes of the Thirty](#) · 86 passages
- [κατὰ Ἐργοκλέους ἐπίλογος](#) · [Against Ergocles, Epilogue](#) · 15 passages
- [κατὰ Νικομάχου γραμματέως εὐθυνῶν κατηγορία](#) · [Against Nicomachus Secretary-Accounts](#) · 34 passages
- [κατὰ Παγκλέωνος ὅτι οὐκ ἦν Πλαταιεύς](#) · [Against Panceleon Not Being Plataean](#) · 14 passages
- [κατὰ Φίλωνος δοκιμασίας](#) · [Against Philo-Examination](#) · 25 passages
- [κατὰ Φιλοκράτους ἐπίλογος](#) · [Against Philocrates, Epilogue](#) · 15 passages

- κατὰ τῶν σιτοπωλῶν · Against The Grain Dealers · 18 passages
- Πρὸς τὴν εἰσαγγελίαν περὶ τοῦ μὴ δίδοσθαι τῷ Ἀγανθῶ · Against the Indictment-Not Giving Money to the Weak · 26 passages
- κατὰ Θεομνήστου, Α · Against Theomnestus A · 28 passages
- κατὰ Θεομνήστου Β · Against Theomnestus B · 11 passages
- Ἀρεοπαγιτικός περὶ τοῦ σηκοῦ ἀπολογία · Areopagiticus Defense of the Shrine · 37 passages
- ὑπὲρ Καλλίου ἱεροσυλίας ἀπολογία · Defense for Callias' Sacrilege · 6 passages
- ἐν βουλῇ Μαντιθέω δοκιμαζομένῳ ἀπολογία · Defense in the Council for Mantitheus Under Examination · 17 passages
- ὑπὲρ τοῦ Ἐρατοσθένους φόνου ἀπολογία · Defense in the Murder of Eratosthenes · 41 passages
- δήμου καταλύσεως ἀπολογία · Defense of the Overthrow of the People · 33 passages
- Ἐπιτάφιος τοῖς Κορινθίων βοηθοῖς · Epitaph for Corinthian Helpers · 48 passages
- ὑπὲρ Πολυστράτου · For Polystratus · 35 passages
- ὑπὲρ τοῦ στρατιωτοῦ · For the Soldier · 17 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Χρέους · Fragments on a Debt Case · 42 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Δικῶν · Fragments on Legal Disputes · 38 passages
- ὑπὲρ τῶν Ἀριστοφάνους χρημάτων, πρὸς τὸ δημόσιον · In Defense of Aristophanes' Funds, to the Public · 60 passages
- Ολυμπιακός · Olympic · 8 passages
- περὶ τοῦ μὴ καταλῦσαι τὴν πάτριον πολιτείαν · On Not Abolishing The Ancestral Constitution At Athens · 8 passages
- περὶ τῆς δημεύσεως τῶν τοῦ Νικίου ἀδελφοῦ ἐπίλογος · On the Confiscation of the Property of Nicias' Brother, Epilogue · 20 passages
- περὶ τῆς Εὐάνδρου δοκιμασίας · On the Examination of Evander · 24 passages
- περὶ τῶν Ἐράτωνος χρημάτων: πρὸς τὸ δημόσιον · On the Funds of Eratones, to the Public · 11 passages
- περὶ τραύματος ἐκ προνοίας, ὑπὲρ οὗ καὶ πρὸς ὃν · On Wound by Design, For Which and to Whom Unknown · 18 passages
- πρὸς Σίμωνα ἀπολογία · To Simon Apology · 38 passages
- ἀπολογία δωροδοκίας ἀπαράσημος · Unmarked Defense of Bribery · 23 passages